

Bhanu Prakash Srivastava's postings

- 1.5 years at Ghaziabad
- 10 years at Kotdwara
- 3 years at New York, USA
- 10 years in Kotdwara
- 7 years at Ghaziabad
- 2007 onwards at Bengaluru

While he told the seniors that he was open to being posted at any of the locations that BEL operates in, the process required him to mention names of two cities he wanted to be posted in. Srivastava mentioned Ghaziabad and Kotdwara as the top two choices.

As Kotdwara was a remote place and very few opted for that, he was selected for the Kotdwara unit and posted to the Ghaziabad unit for initial training. For general information, the Ghaziabad unit is considered one of the most sought-after postings in the organisation as it not only gives one proximity to seniors but also opportunities to work on technologies that are among the prime interests of the nation. However, little did Srivastava of that time know that Kotdwara, the city that he mentioned on his posting preference form at BEL, would prove to be one of the best opportunities for him.

On completion of around 1.5 years at BEL's Ghaziabad unit, he was moved to Kotdwara. "Many saw this as a backtrack of my career at BEL, but it turned out to be a blessing for me," he says.

Why was it so hard to be posted at Kotdwara for a lot of people? The city is located about 200 kilometres away from Delhi. In today's Uttarakhand, this city back in time (around 1985 to 1990) did not have amenities like telephone lines, proper medical facilities, and a lot of other things. As this unit of BEL was new, the availability of these amenities would have

taken a few more years to come.

"One needed to travel at least 100 kilometres one way to make a telephone call to his/her family. There were many more significant challenges. But more than those, the opportunities were the biggest," he shares.

What Srivastava saw at Kotdwara was an opportunity to work in a senior role as the facility did not have a lot of presence of seniors back then. It meant a lot of exposure to work and an opportunity to prove his worth at BEL. Srivastava remained positioned at the Kotdwara unit for the next ten years! During this time frame, he developed expertise in numerous projects and technologies. And what happened at the end of those ten years?

He was selected among many aspirants to work at BEL's office in New York, United States of America. Srivastava got a chance to work on procurement for all the projects spread across all the geographies BEL was operating in. As Srivastava informs, "The opportunity gave him a chance to learn about all the technologies, products, and solutions that BEL was working on. As I was in the procurement division, I was responsible for sourcing components for all the projects; this was a challenging yet superb posting for me."

Firefighting on the international podium

One of the core principles of Srivastava has been not to be choosy. Rather, he has concentrated on developing a passion for whatever he has been entrusted with. He says, "I chose BEL to serve my country and made it a point that everything chosen by BEL for me would be my destiny. I have learnt it from Ramayana and Mahabharata to be devoted to a cause wholeheartedly!"

In New York, fate was going to try and test Srivastava's resilience





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